

Welcome to SIM-012: The Products We Shouldnt Keep Selling

A Message to the Analyst (Yes, You!)

If you are reading this and thinking, *'I don't know anything about this industry, I've never been a business analyst, and I am not sure if I can do this'*—**Don't Panic!** You do not need prior domain knowledge to succeed in this project. Everything you need is hidden inside the raw data.

Real-World Relevance (Why are you doing this?)

In the real world, companies collect massive amounts of data but struggle to understand **why** things are happening. Management often jumps to conclusions based on surface-level metrics (like total sales or total volume). By completing this project, you will learn how to look past the surface, clean messy data, join different tables together, and find the **root cause** of a business problem. These are the exact skills that top tech companies, consulting firms, and modern businesses look for in Data Analysts.

What You Will Learn & Master

- **Data Integration:** Connecting disparate datasets using VLOOKUP/XLOOKUP in Excel or JOINS in SQL.
- **Metric Calculation:** Building calculated columns to measure performance accurately.
- **Cohort & Segmentation:** Breaking down massive numbers into specific groups to find the anomalies.
- **Business Communication:** Translating raw numbers into actionable, executive-level insights.

How to Start

1. Open the *Data_Dictionary.xlsx* to understand what columns you have.
2. Open the CSV files one by one just to look at the raw data.
3. Follow the *'Recommended Workflow'* in the main Case Study document step-by-step.
4. Take it one row, one formula, and one query at a time. You've got this!